

RJ CAD Solutions Inc

How a CAD Drafting Firm Tripled Its Google Ads Leads on a Flat Budget

CAD Drafting & Permit Drawings · Greater Toronto Area, Canada · Managed since Jan 2023

~55

LEADS / MONTH

Q2 2026 (Apr–Jun)

~\$51

COST PER LEAD

▼ from ~\$162 at launch

~12%

CONVERSION RATE

▲ from ~5.6% at launch

PPC Guru launched and scaled a CAD drafting and permit-drawing firm's Google Ads from the ground up. Holding monthly budget essentially flat at around \$2,900, the account grew from 18 genuine calls and form leads in its first month to roughly 55 a month in the most recent quarter (Apr–Jun 2026) — cutting cost per lead from about \$162 to about \$51 through structure and search-term discipline, not extra spend.

About the Client

The client is a CAD drafting and engineering-drawing firm serving the Greater Toronto Area, producing technical drawings and city-permit drawing packages for renovation and construction projects. Its enquiries come from property owners, contractors and builders searching for drafting and permit help — high-intent phone calls and form submissions. Google Ads is the firm's primary channel for capturing that demand at the moment people are looking for a drafter.

How the Account Came to PPC Guru

The firm partnered with PPC Guru to build its Google Ads presence from scratch in January 2023. Rather than starting small and ramping, the account launched at a full working budget of around \$2,900 a month, with the goal of turning search demand for drafting and permit drawings into a predictable flow of enquiries. From day one the brief was clear: measurable calls and form leads, not just clicks.

The Challenge

Building a new account for a specialised service is a cold start: no historical conversion data, and drafting and permit searches sit alongside plenty of loosely related queries. Early on the campaigns drew heavy traffic — several thousand clicks a month — at a cost per lead north of \$160. The challenge was to convert that raw traffic into qualified drafting and permit enquiries and drive the cost per lead down, all without increasing the monthly budget.

What We Analyzed & Planned

PPC Guru built the account around the two highest-value demand pockets — general drafting services and city-permit drawings for the GTA — and wired up genuine call and lead-form tracking before optimising. Early months deliberately cast a wide net to gather search-term data; the work from there was disciplined refinement: cutting irrelevant queries, concentrating budget on converting searches, and letting Maximize Conversions bidding compound the gains.

- Launch dedicated Search campaigns for drafting services and city-permit drawings (GTA).
- Track genuine phone calls and lead-form submissions, including a dedicated permit-offer landing page.
- Mine early search-term data and build out negatives to cut wasted clicks.
- Run Maximize Conversions bidding and let cost per lead fall as the data matured — without raising budget.

What PPC Guru Did & Why

Two focused Search campaigns	Separating general drafting from city-permit drawings let each get the right message, keywords and budget share.
Genuine call + form tracking	Measured real phone calls and lead-form submissions — including a dedicated permit-offer page — instead of counting button clicks.
Aggressive search-term refinement	Early broad traffic (up to ~4,800 clicks/mo) was pruned with negatives so budget reached genuine drafting intent.
Maximize Conversions bidding	With clean lead data, automated bidding steadily lowered cost per lead on the same spend.
Held budget flat	Growth came from efficiency, not more money — the same ~\$2,900 a month produced roughly three times the leads.

UNDER THE HOOD

Campaign type	Search (2 campaigns)
Bidding strategy	Maximize Conversions
Campaigns	Drafting Services · City Permit (GTA)
Monthly budget	≈ \$2,800 CAD (flat)
Lead signals	Phone calls + lead forms
Offer	Permit-drawing offer landing page

The Growth Timeline

- Jan 2023 Launch month — 18 genuine call and form leads at about \$162 each, on a ~\$2,900 budget.
- Q1 2023 First full quarter — about 84 leads (roughly 28 a month) as early search-term data came in.
- 2024 Steady volume around 50–60 leads a month as negatives and structure tightened.
- 2025 Consistent lead flow on the same flat budget, cost per lead holding well below launch levels.
- Q2 2026 (Apr–Jun) About 55 genuine leads a month at roughly \$51 each — cost per lead cut by about two-thirds versus launch.

The First 90 Days

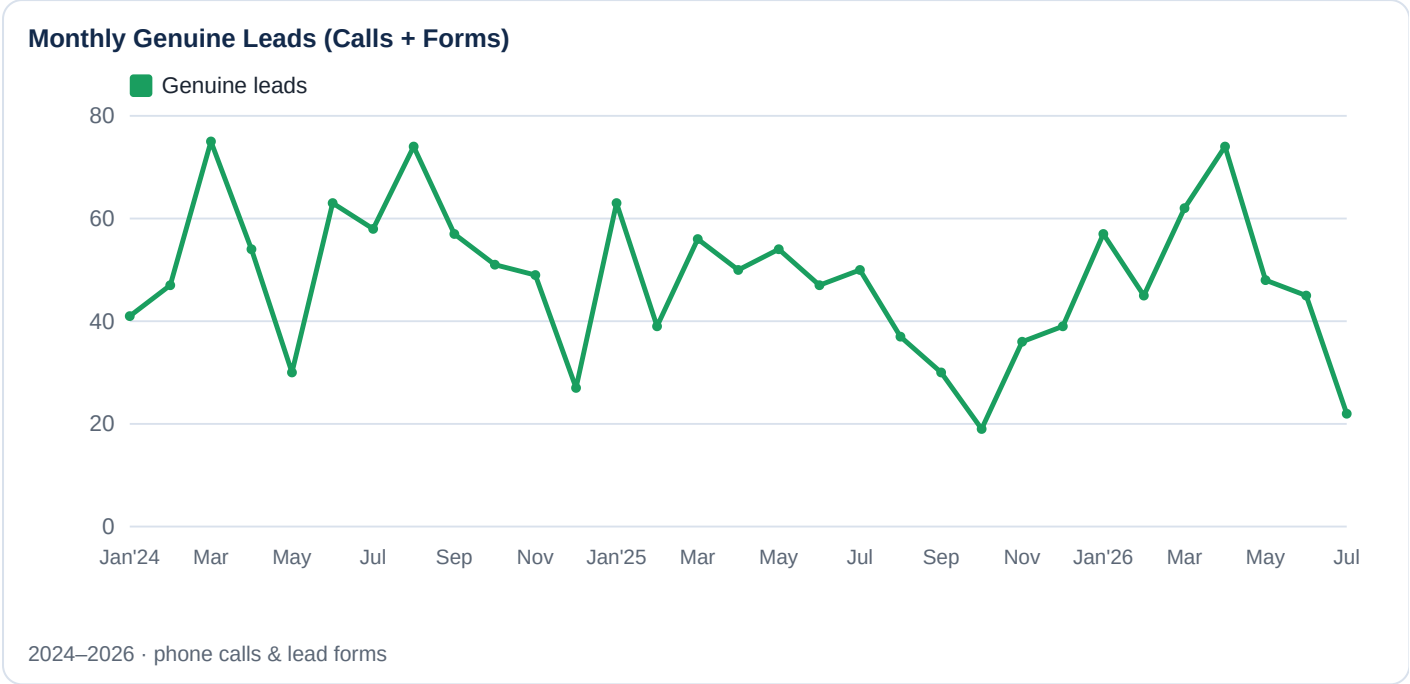
The account launched at full budget and immediately produced measurable leads, then improved fast as search-term data accumulated. Cost per lead more than halved between the first and third month as negatives took hold.

Period	Spend	Genuine Leads	Cost / Lead
Month 1 (Jan 2023)	\$2,912.69	18	\$161.82
Month 2 (Feb 2023)	\$2,853.98	23	\$124.09
Month 3 (Mar 2023)	\$2,958.15	43	\$68.79

Gradual Improvement, Month by Month

From that fast start the account settled into a dependable rhythm. Through 2024 it held around 50–60 genuine leads a month, and it has stayed in that band through 2025 and into 2026 — all on the same flat budget. The monthly trend

below shows the natural variation of a real account around a consistent, efficient baseline, with cost per lead holding far below where it launched.



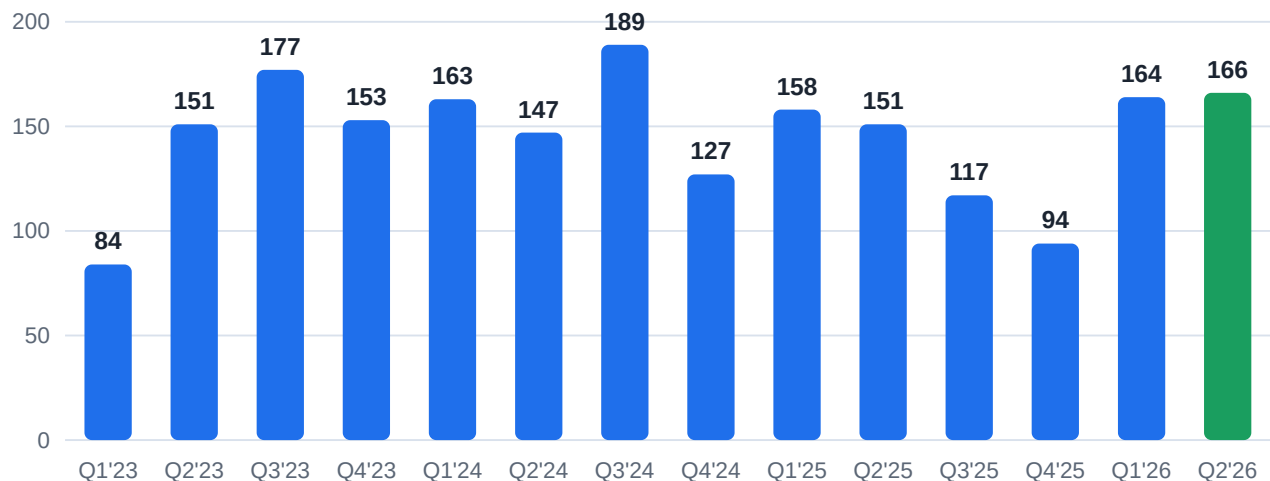
Results

Metric	Then (Jan 2023, launch)	Now (Q2 2026, avg/mo)	Change
Genuine leads / month (calls + forms)	18	≈ 55	▲ About 3× growth
Cost per lead	≈ \$162	≈ \$51	▼ Cut by ~68%
Conversion rate	≈ 5.6%	≈ 12%	▲ More than doubled
Monthly ad spend	≈ \$2,910	≈ \$2,800	Held flat

All figures are genuine phone-call and lead-form conversions; Google local actions and click-to-call taps on the Business Profile are excluded. Because the monthly budget was essentially unchanged from launch to now, the fall in cost per lead — from about \$162 to about \$51 — reflects sharper targeting and bidding rather than extra spend.

Lead quality: Leads are a mix of direct phone calls and website lead-form submissions, including enquiries from a dedicated permit-drawing offer page — both high-intent actions for a drafting and permit business.

Quarterly Tracked Leads Since PPC Guru Takeover



Genuine leads (calls + forms) per quarter · Google Ads

Why It Worked

- ✓ Two focused Search campaigns matched budget to the firm's highest-value services.
- ✓ Genuine call and form tracking let bidding optimise toward real enquiries from launch.
- ✓ Disciplined search-term and negative-keyword work drove cost per lead down over time.
- ✓ Growth came from efficiency on a flat budget, making the channel sustainable.

Why a Flat Budget Tells the Real Story

It is easy to grow leads by spending more. This account did the opposite: monthly budget barely moved from launch to today, yet leads roughly tripled and cost per lead fell by about two-thirds. That gap is the value of the management itself — every additional lead came from better keyword targeting, tighter negatives and smarter bidding, not a bigger cheque. For a specialised drafting and permit business, that efficiency is what makes the channel sustainable.

Lessons for Service-Business Owners

- 1 A new account is a data-gathering exercise first — expect a higher cost per lead in month one and judge it on the trend.
- 2 Separate distinct services (general drafting vs permit drawings) so each gets the right keywords and budget.
- 3 Negatives are where the savings live — prune irrelevant searches relentlessly in the early months.
- 4 Track genuine calls and form submissions, not button clicks, so bidding optimises toward real enquiries.
- 5 More leads don't require more budget — efficiency on a flat spend is often the bigger win.

Where They Stand Today

Today the firm runs a predictable Google Ads program that turns GTA search demand for drafting and permit drawings into a steady flow of enquiries. In the most recent complete quarter (April–June 2026) the account generated about 55 genuine call and form leads a month at roughly \$51 each — up from 18 leads at about \$162 each in its launch month, on essentially the same budget. With cost per lead cut by about two-thirds through management alone, the firm has a dependable, efficient channel it can rely on.

Want results like these?

PPC Guru helps Canadian service businesses turn search demand into measurable phone-call and form leads with conversion-focused Google Ads and transparent reporting.



SCAN TO
BOOK

All figures are pulled directly from the client's Google Ads account and shown on a monthly basis. 'Leads' are genuine phone calls and lead-form submissions only; Google local actions and click-to-call taps are excluded. 'Then' is the first complete month under management (January 2023); 'Now' is the most recent complete quarter (April–June 2026). Monthly budget was essentially flat across the whole period.

Advertising results vary based on industry, market conditions, competition, budget, campaign history, offer, website experience, conversion tracking, and other factors. The results reflect the specific account and reporting periods shown and do not guarantee future performance.

© PPC Guru — Canadian Digital Marketing Agency

ppcguru.ca